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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 2

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Notes

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The mathematics syllabus is published by the Ministry of Education, Singapore.

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word, and one or two wrong answers very rarely do. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-20) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-13, S2-19) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as comparing amounts of money, lengths of lessons given in hours and minutes and printed facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, not actual size (smaller than real) and in black and white.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Use normal toner, not a light setting: on the coin pages (Dollars and Cents, Purse Match) a light setting can fill in the small word cents on the coins. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Pictures are not actual size. Real $2 notes are purple, $5 green, $10 red.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P2-06	Dollars and Cents	1 star
S2-02	P2-16	Writing Money	2 stars
S2-03	P2-23	Which Costs More?	2 stars
S2-04	P2-24	Purse Match	2 stars
S2-05	P2-08	Metres	1 star
S2-06	P2-25	Kilograms and Grams	1 star
S2-07	P2-26	Litres	1 star
S2-08	P2-27	Which Unit?	1 star
S2-09	P2-28	Order the Measures	2 stars
S2-10	P2-07	Time to the Minute	1 star
S2-11	P2-30	Hours and Minutes	1 star
S2-12	P2-29	Match the Times	2 stars
S2-13	P2-31	Time Detective	2 stars
S2-14	P2-32	Shape Patterns	1 star
S2-15	P2-33	Pattern Rules	2 stars
S2-16	P2-34	Meet the Solids	1 star
S2-17	P2-35	Solid Sort	2 stars
S2-18	P2-36	Picture Graph Scales	1 star
S2-19	P2-37	Graph Detective Two	2 stars
S2-20	P2-40	Colour the Butterfly	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

What the booklet covers

Money 1.1 counting amount of money in dollars and cents **S2-01, S2-04, S2-20**

Money 1.2 reading and writing money in decimal notation **S2-01, S2-02, S2-03, S2-04, S2-20**

Money 1.3 comparing two or three amounts of money **S2-03, S2-20**

Money 1.4 converting an amount of money in decimal notation to cents only, and vice versa **S2-02, S2-20**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.1 measuring (length in metres; mass in kilograms/grams; volume of liquid in litres) **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-09**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.2 using appropriate units of measurement and their abbreviations m, g, kg, ℓ **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-08**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.3 comparing and ordering (lengths; masses; volumes) **S2-09**

Time 2.1 telling time to the minute **S2-10, S2-12, S2-13**

Time 2.2 measuring time in hours and minutes **S2-13**

Time 2.3 converting time in hours and minutes to minutes only, and vice versa **S2-11, S2-13**

2D Shapes 1.1 making/completing patterns with 2D shapes according to one or two of the following attributes (size; shape; colour; orientation) **S2-14, S2-15**

3D Shapes 2.1 identifying, naming, describing and classifying 3D shapes (cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder, sphere) **S2-16, S2-17**

Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1 reading and interpreting data from picture graphs with scales **S2-18, S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.6; Addition and Subtraction 2.1; Addition and Subtraction 2.2; Multiplication and Division 3.1; Multiplication and Division 3.2; Multiplication and Division 3.3; Multiplication and Division 3.4; Multiplication and Division 3.5; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 1.3; Fractions 2.1.